

28420

Paper-I

Part—I (GENERAL ENGLISH)

(Descriptive Type)

Full Marks : 100

Time : 2 hours

*The figures in the margin indicate full marks
for the questions*

1. Write a précis on any one of the following passages : 20

(a) Anytime we do something that requires fossil fuel like riding a car, travelling in an aeroplane, buying something, eating something, keeping the lights of our homes on, running the ACs or maybe watching TV—we emit carbon dioxide. Our individual carbon dioxide emissions are a part of the total emissions on Earth. Our habit of buying clothes without actually requiring so many is also included in our personal carbon footprint. The key to our heavy strain on the environment can lie in choosing alternative resources of power,

consciously saving energy, water, reducing waste and even planting trees. We are regularly being informed about the poor AQI level of Delhi, particularly in the autumnal months. Urban spaces have been choked and the residents are facing respiratory problems along with a low quality of life. Urban gardens are small oases of life. People are turning to rooftop gardens, container gardens, gardens in patios, balconies and yards. These efforts are sustainable strides towards reducing our own carbon footprints. The integration of urban farming into city planning is gaining credence as residents realise the twin benefits of pleasure and improving urban resilience. The urban local administrative bodies also admit that this is a potential transformative movement in urban development. Urban farming faces challenges of land availability regulatory hurdles and continuous investment. Nonetheless, a growing commitment to sustainable development is a pervading positive attitude. Choosing our own consumption based on local products and start growing our own produce can reduce our personal carbon footprint.

(b) The stretch of rocky hills and plateaus in the 'heart of India' are home to prehistoric rock paintings, which yet survive stamped with power and energy. The earliest traces of human life and signs of Stone Age habitation are exhibited over these sites. The Vindhya Range in Central India has the Bhimbetka rock shelters. Animals, scenes of hunting, men-women working in forests, on land are painted in green, red, brown, black and white. Depiction of nomadic life graduates to scenes of wars, weapons, processions and rituals. The hunter-gatherers had given way to early stages of civilization and domesticated animals. Hunting scenes show scenes of fleeing from wild animals, scenes of humans with bows and arrows. The scenes of procession are characterized by a marked absence of animal figures. It is believed that these paintings were not meant to beautify or decorate humans' living spaces. Their historicity can be measured from the overlapping paintings, successively done over time-periods. The deep red pigment was perhaps obtained from haematite. The colours were made by grinding various rocks and minerals. The rock-arts of

Bhimbetka are as old as 30000 years. Therefore it is one of the oldest prehistoric complexes, corresponding to the Indian Mesolithic period. Such a prehistoric complex with paintings and artefacts such as the Acheulean stone tool have been discovered only in 1957, surrounded by dense teak forests and cultivated fields. These paintings are the earliest evidence of art in South Asia. They also show elephants, deer, bison and swamp deer.

2. Write an essay on any *one* of the following topics : 40

- (a) The environmental cost of fast fashion
- (b) The importance of preserving cultural heritage in an era of globalization
- (c) Is technology making us more distant than connected to people?
- (d) Use of banned substances : a health problem or a criminal offence

3. Draft any *one* of the following : 20

- (a) A standing committee visited various sections/divisions of a department to study the use of the local language in their work. As the secretary of the department, draft a note for approval of

the senior-most secretary to issue a guideline to the establishment and general sections to conduct all work in the local language.

- (b) Draft a letter to the District Collector to highlight damage to the green cover around your city and propose a stop to the felling of trees.
- (c) A sudden violence broke out between the local people living around a tea garden and the adjoining police station because of road diversion. Draft a report, as a local officer, to your senior officer on the whole episode and the steps taken to restore peace.
- (d) Draft a letter to the Minister of Health and Family Welfare to request intervention in your local Public Health Centre regarding scarcity of vaccines for children and medicines.

4. (a) Answer the following : 10

- (i) Make sentences with the pairs given below, to show how each word is different in meaning from the other : 2×3=6

- 1. Forlorn; Miserable
- 2. Hew; Hue
- 3. Might; Mite

(ii) Make sentences with the following idioms : 2×2=4

1. On a high horse
2. Go around in circles

(b) Answer the following as directed : 1×10=10

(i) The man was known for his audacity in challenging the official order.

(Give the antonym of 'audacity')

(ii) Choose the correct synonym of 'scrutiny' from the given options :

1. Bifurcation
2. Dereliction
3. Candor
4. Perusal

(iii) Neither the manager nor the employees was aware of the new policy. (Correct the sentence)

(iv) The committee will announce the results tomorrow.

(Give the passive form of the sentence)

(v) By the time we arrive, the movie _____ (start).

(Write the correct tense of the verb given in the bracket)

(vi) Seema had cooked dinner therefore
ramesh will wash the dishes
(Punctuate the sentence)

(vii) The team are winning their game.
(Write the correct subject-verb
agreement)

(viii) Although we had revised everything
several times, everything went
wrong.
(Use the word 'despite' and change
the structure of the sentence)

(ix) These oranges are sold _____ the
dozen.
(Fill in the blank with appropriate
preposition)

(x) She is too haughty to listen to
advice.
(Change into a complex sentence)

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